80s Gated Snare

Sounds like: Phil Collins "In the Air Tonight" / 80s power ballads

ACCURACY A

Stock Reason nails this sound.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`Snare channel -> RV7000 MkII (insert, not send) -> channel strip EQ`

Starting material: any decent snare hit — sampled or acoustic

---

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. Insert RV7000 MkII directly on the snare channel (not as a send — you want the gate to chop the whole tail).

2. Algorithm: Hall. Decay 2.5–3 s. Size large. Predelay 0.

3. Press the GATE button on the RV7000. Open the gate section (Remote Programmer).

4. Gate: threshold so the gate opens only on hits; hold ~120–180 ms; release fast (under 50 ms). The abrupt cutoff IS the sound.

5. Dry/Wet around 45–55% — the snare crack must still lead.

6. Channel strip EQ after: boost 3 dB at 200 Hz for body, 2 dB shelf at 8 kHz for sizzle.

Why this works
A huge reverb chopped mid-bloom reads as "massive room" without the tail eating the next beat.

Why this order
EQ after the reverb so you shape the combined sound, not just the dry hit.

Reason trick
The RV7000's gate can also be triggered by CV — run a Redrum channel's gate out into it and the reverb chops in rhythm even on sustained sources.

The skill you just learned
Gated reverb — and more broadly, that a reverb's envelope matters as much as its size.

Worth buying?
None. Stock wins here.